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OnlyOffice on HTTPS with NextCloud and NGINX



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I have **the workaround** to onlyoffice on HTTPS.

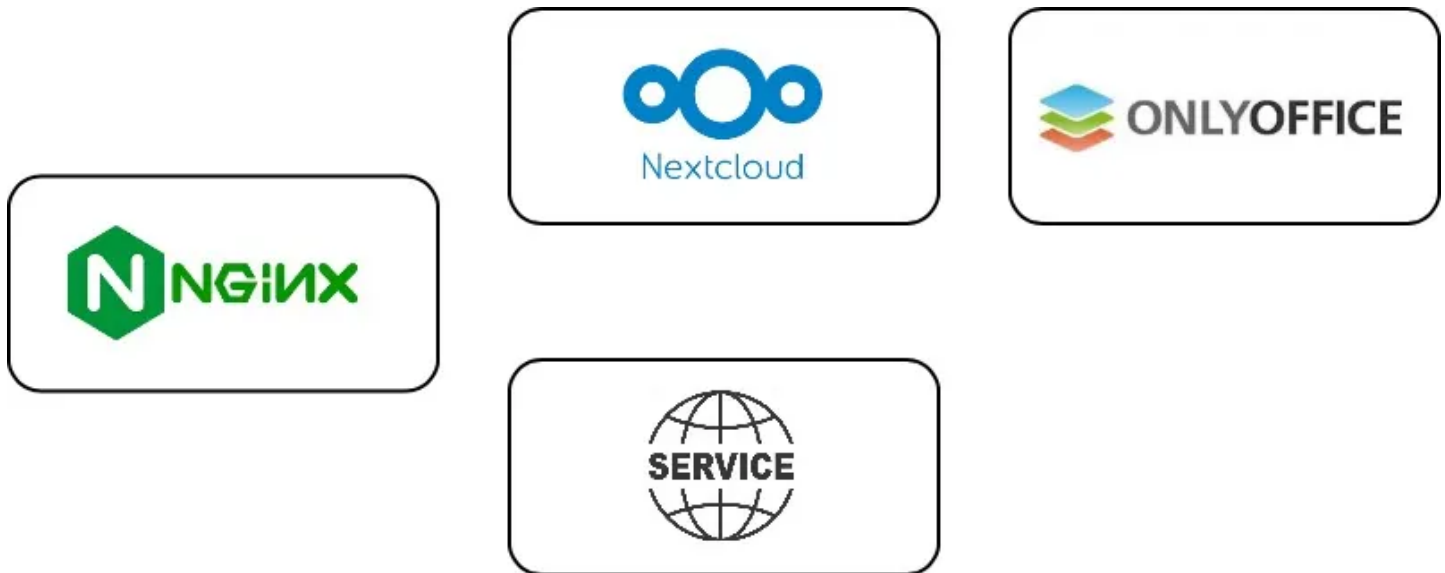
As a DevOps engineer working across various projects, I recently found myself tackling an issue while **deploying OnlyOffice behind HTTPS**. While everything worked perfectly on HTTP, moving to HTTPS brought up a frustrating roadblock. Here's a breakdown of my experience and how I solved it.



Photo by [Summan Mehmood](#) on [Unsplash](#)

Environment

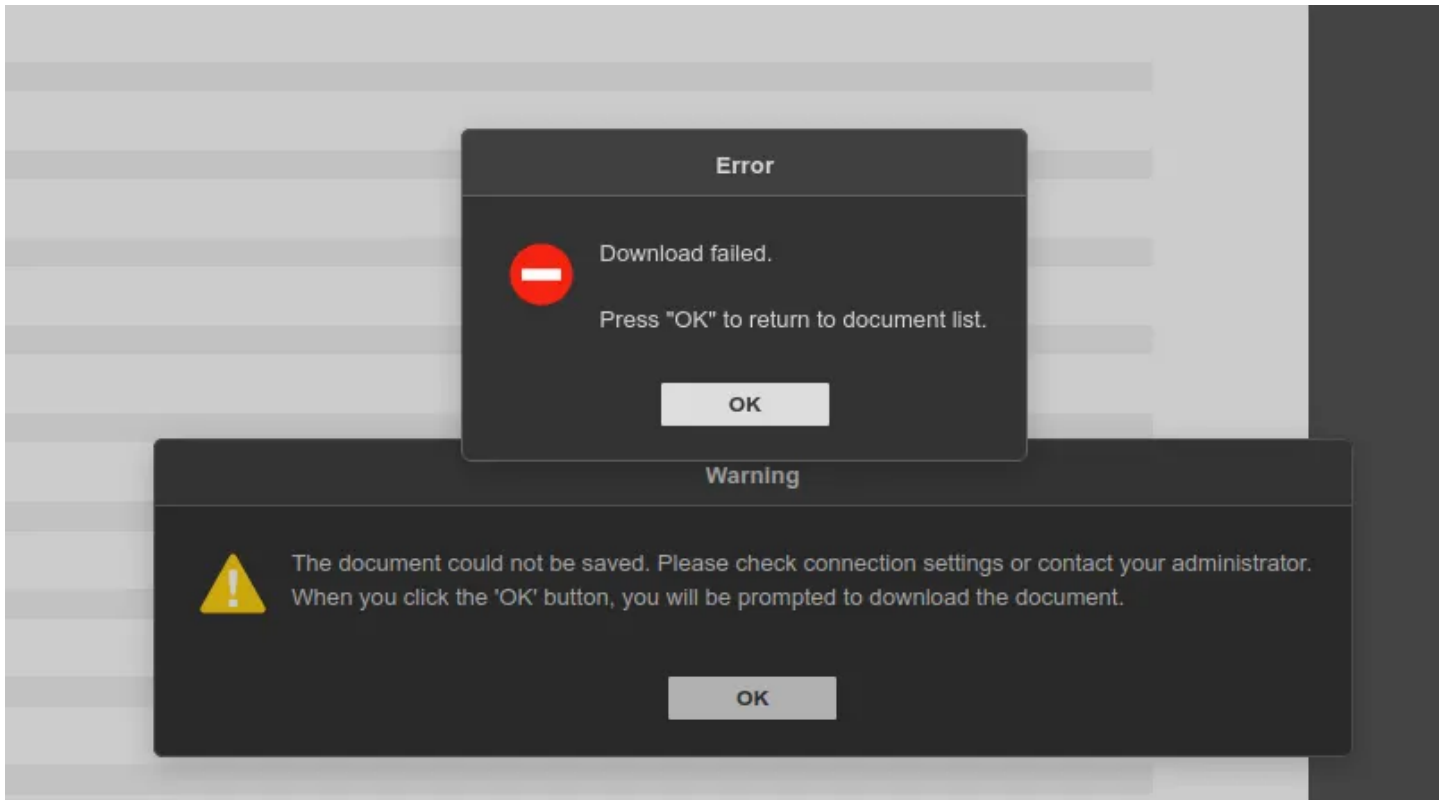
I deployed a **Docker Compose** setup using the [official repository](#) for integrating OnlyOffice with NextCloud. My stack included NGINX as a **reverse proxy** (since I had a custom web service in the mix), OnlyOffice, and NextCloud. Everything was running smoothly under HTTP. However, once I switched to HTTPS, the trouble started.



My docker containers

While my web service remained fully functional and NextCloud was accessible, OnlyOffice wouldn't allow me to edit documents. Instead, I was greeted with the warning and error: *"The document could not be saved."* *"Download failed."* After spending hours combing through logs and documentation, I finally found a few crucial fixes.

| *Let me know if you've encountered this issue before and how you resolved it.*



1 warning and 1 error

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Analysis: The Problem with HTTPS

The core issue lay with how OnlyOffice interacts with NextCloud and NGINX when HTTPS is enforced. Although the connections were established, the document editing feature on OnlyOffice simply wouldn't work. Based on my debugging, I identified a few key areas that required attention: trusted domains, the Storage URL, and certificate validation on OnlyOffice's side.

Solutions

1. Trusted Domains

My first step was to ensure that NextCloud's trusted domains configuration was correct. If your domains are not properly listed, the communication between NextCloud and OnlyOffice breaks. To verify, I ran the following command:

```
docker exec -u www-data storage-nextcloud php occ --no-warnings config:system:g
```

It's crucial that all versions of your domain (with and without "www") are listed. In my case, adding both domain variations was necessary.

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2. Verify the Storage URL

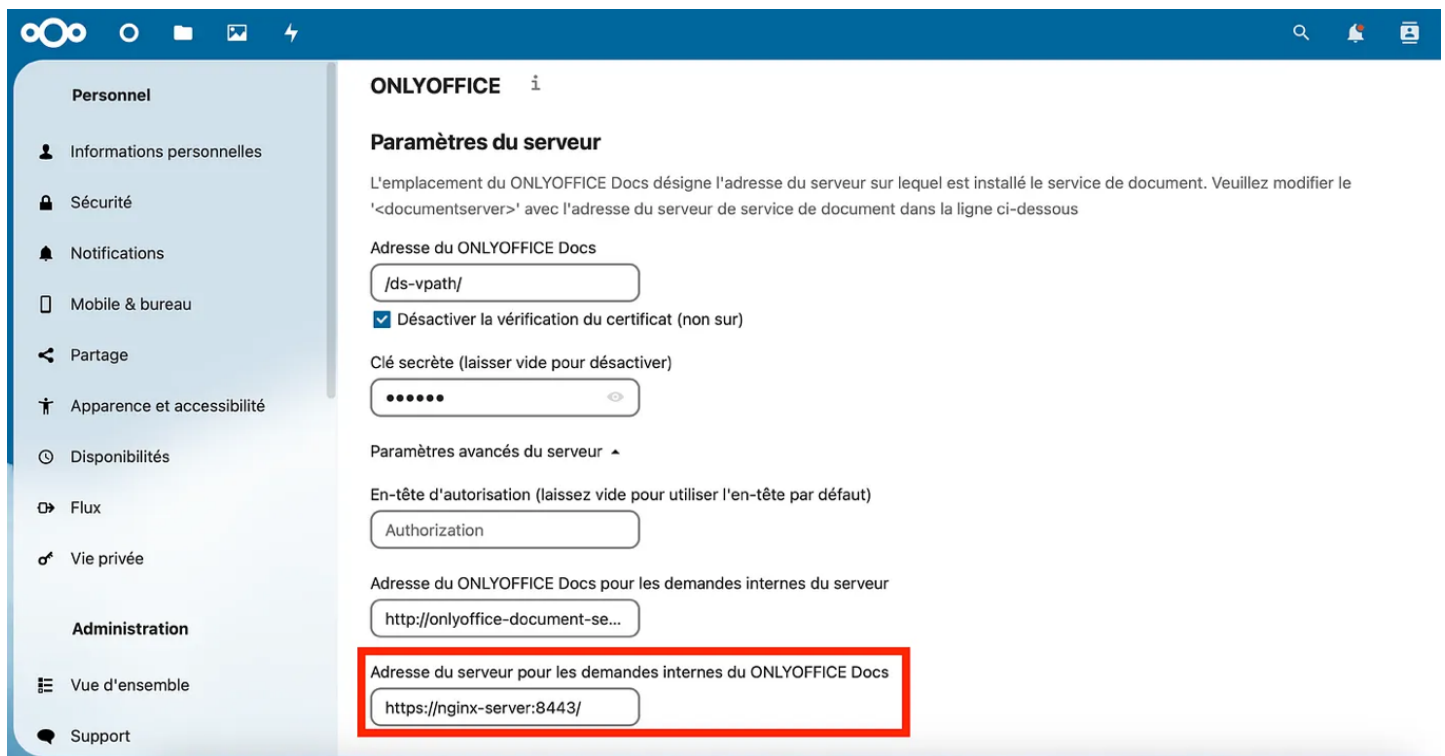
Next, I checked the Storage URL setting for OnlyOffice in NextCloud. Even a minor misconfiguration here can cause the service to fail. My mistake was omitting the trailing slash (/) at the end of the URL, which led to issues

when trying to download.

Here's the command I used to set the correct Storage URL:

```
docker exec -u www-data storage-nextcloud php occ --no-warnings config:system:s
```

You can also edit this URL on the admin dashboard of NextCloud.



In french but you get it.

3. Disable 'rejectUnauthorized'

This step is more of a workaround than an official fix, and **it should be applied with caution**. OnlyOffice's Document Server, by default, validates SSL certificates. If the certificate chain is not entirely trusted or there are any inconsistencies, OnlyOffice may refuse to connect.

To bypass this, I disabled certificate validation by setting the *rejectUnauthorized* parameter to false. This is done by editing the configuration file at `/etc/onlyoffice/documentserver/default.json`:

```
{  
  "rejectUnauthorized": false  
}
```

Here is the script if you haven't changed the names of the services from the [Git repository](#). First connect to your server, then :

```
docker cp onlyoffice-document-server:/etc/onlyoffice/documentserver/default.json  
jq '.services.CoAuthoring.requestDefaults.rejectUnauthorized = false' default.json  
docker cp default.json onlyoffice-document-server:/etc/onlyoffice/documentserver/  
docker exec -it -d onlyoffice-document-server ./app/ds/run-document-server.sh
```

While this fixed the issue, it's important to note that disabling SSL validation can

expose your setup to potential security risks, so use this approach sparingly. Let me know what you think of this last one.

Conclusion

Deploying OnlyOffice behind HTTPS turned out to be more complex than expected, but the key to solving the issue lay in careful configuration of **trusted domains**, ensuring the **Storage URL** was correct (including the trailing slash), and disabling **certificate validation** as a last resort. With these adjustments, OnlyOffice and NextCloud now work seamlessly over HTTPS, allowing me to edit documents without any hiccups.

For anyone else facing similar issues, these solutions should get you back on track, but remember to handle SSL certificate validation with care to avoid potential security vulnerabilities.

⚠ I strongly recommend to set up a firewall ⚠

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